Canadian Family Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right. Your TFSAs, your RRSPs and your family's RESPs live side by side, at up to 8 brokerages. The tracker counts one TFSA room and one RRSP room for all your accounts, and gives every child their own $50,000 lifetime limit and CESG count across every RESP, the way the CRA and ESDC count them.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue cell	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Account, Child, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.
Navy / Green / Purple / Slate	TFSA / RRSP / RESP / the whole family.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1KG3PuXlS_0UQdnHHyR6tmMduIZ6jwoBMvPLImC3oeaQ/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds all 10 tabs. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Sort Transaction Log by Date	Puts every row in date order. Use it if you logged something late.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample family: TFSAs at Wealthsimple and Questrade, RRSPs at RBC and TD, and a family RESP for Emma (born 2015) and Liam (born 2019) at Wealthsimple and RBC. Prices come from today's market. Replaces anything in the log.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B5 to B8	Your family name, province, Active Year and your birth year.	Change B7 every January. B9 shows your RRIF year.
B13 to B20	Up to 8 brokerages where you have a TFSA, RRSP or RESP.	Use exactly the same name every time.
B23	The TFSA annual limit for the Active Year ($7,000 for 2026).	Update every January.
B24	Your TFSA room on January 1, from CRA My Account.	One number for ALL your TFSAs.

Cell	What to enter	Notes
B31	Your RRSP deduction limit, from your Notice of Assessment.	It already includes unused room carried forward.
B32	Unused RRSP contributions, from the same notice (often $0).	B33 = B31 – B32, automatically.
B34	The $2,000 lifetime over-contribution buffer.	Rarely changes. B35 shows the deadline.
B43, B44	The year your oldest RESP was opened, and Family or Individual plan.	Sets the 31-year and 35-year dates.
B47 to E47	Each child's name (up to 4).	The names feed the Child dropdown.
B48 to E48	Each child's birth year.	Sets grant room and the last CESG year.
B49 to E49	RESP contributions for that child BEFORE the Active Year, by anyone, at any brokerage.	From your RESP statements.
B50 to E50	CESG received for that child before the Active Year.	From your RESP statements.
B72 to B78	Your family goals: TFSA, RRSP and RESP contributions, education savings, the year school starts, dividend income and family net worth.	Shown with progress bars on the Family Dashboard.
B81, B82	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B82 blank to use the live rate.

The grey cells are a quick reference for each account (limits, deadlines, withholding, the CESG numbers). At the bottom are two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4, in date order. Never delete old rows: your room, your children's limits and your holdings depend on the full history. **Already own investments?** Log each holding once as a Buy dated the day you start, with column M = what it cost you. Log this year's contributions, withdrawals and grants with their real dates; earlier RESP contributions and CESG go in Settings rows 49 and 50.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The trade or contribution date (yyyy-mm-dd). For an RRSP contribution the date matters: January 1 to March 1 counts for LAST year's room.
B	Year	Automatic.
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B13:B20.
D	Account	**TFSA, RRSP or RESP. Pick it on every row.** It decides which portfolio and which room the row counts in.
E	Child	**RESP rows only.** Pick the child on every Contribution, CESG, CLB, Provincial Grant and EAP. Buys, sells and dividends in a family plan can leave it blank.
F	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
G	Ticker	With the exchange prefix: TSE:XEQT, TSE:RY, NYSE:JNJ. Blank for contributions and grants.
H	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
I	Currency	CAD or USD.
J to L	Shares, Price, Commission	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
M	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency. Leave blank on a Buy or Sell and it is calculated.
N, O	FX Rate, Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up column O.
P	Check	Automatic. Flags a missing institution, account, type, child, ticker, shares or amount, an RESP-only type in a TFSA or RRSP, a child on a non-RESP row, and rows out of date order.

Type	Use it for
Contribution	Money you put in. Uses TFSA room, RRSP room, or the child's $50,000 RESP limit.
Withdrawal	TFSA or RRSP money out. A TFSA withdrawal comes back as room next January 1; an RRSP withdrawal is taxed and never comes back. RESPs use the types below instead.
Buy / Sell	Shares, price and commission.
Dividend / DRIP	Cash dividend, or a dividend reinvested in new shares. Log US dividends at the GROSS amount.
Fee	Account or admin fees.
Transfer Out / Transfer In	A direct transfer between two of your accounts of the same kind at different brokerages. With a ticker and shares it moves shares; with no ticker it moves cash. Not a contribution.
CESG / CLB / Provincial Grant	RESP only. Grants paid into the RESP, with the child.
EAP	RESP only. Educational Assistance Payment (grants + growth) paid to a student, with the child.
PSE Withdrawal	RESP only. Your own contributions taken back while a child is in school (tax-free).
Non-Educational Withdrawal / AIP / Grant Repayment	RESP only. Contributions taken back when nobody goes to school, the Accumulated Income Payment, and grants repaid.

3. FAMILY DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
Big cards	Your TFSA, RRSP and RESP value (holdings at live prices + cash) and the family total, with your room left, the CESG collected this year and the gain.
Brokerage cards	One column per brokerage plus All Brokerages: each account's value, family value, gain, this year's TFSA, RRSP and RESP contributions, RESP grants and dividends.
TFSA room	Annual limit, room on January 1, contributions this year at every brokerage, room left, withdrawals and the room you get back next January 1.
RRSP room	Deduction limit, unused contributions, available room, contributions from March 2 to March 1 at every brokerage, room left and withdrawals. Warns you inside the $2,000 buffer and turns red beyond it.
Each child's RESP	One column per child: age, contributions this year and lifetime, room left of $50,000, the most CESG available this year, the CESG this year's contributions earn, how much more to contribute for the full grant, CESG lifetime and left of $7,200, other grants and a status. A message line tells you the most important thing to do.
Right column	Last 5 transactions, family goals with progress bars, a tax snapshot (Lines 20800 and 12900, RESP grants, EAPs, AIP) and the RESP timeline with your education goal.
Charts	Family value by brokerage, dividends by month per account, and CESG per child.

4. TFSA, RRSP AND RESP PORTFOLIOS

All three tabs are automatic. Each ticker appears once per tab, with the shares held at every brokerage combined, the average cost, live price in CAD, market value, gain or loss, return and dividends. Below the totals: cash not invested and the total value of that account. **The three accounts never mix:** if you own VBAL in your TFSA and your RESP, each tab has its own VBAL line with its own average cost. None of these numbers goes on this year's tax return.

5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

Every brokerage side by side: TFSA, RRSP and RESP market value and cost, unrealized gain, cash not invested, family value, TFSA contributions this year, RRSP contributions in the March 2 to March 1 window, RESP contributions and grants this year, and dividends. Your TFSA and RRSP room blocks sit underneath. On the right, a donut chart and a table show the share of your family's money at each brokerage.

6. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Cards for income all time, TFSA this year (tax-free), RRSP this year (tax-deferred), RESP this year (sheltered), the monthly average, a full-year estimate and your goal. A note shows the US withholding lost in your TFSA and RESP and the amount saved in your RRSP. Section A splits each month by account; Section B lists every dividend; Section C totals each ticker by account.

7. TFSA, RRSP & RESP RULES

Colour-coded cards: red = costly mistake, amber = limit or deadline, green = benefit. Sections: all three accounts, your TFSA, your RRSP, RESP contributions, RESP grants, paying for school, and which account to fill first. The Government Rules PDF explains each one with examples.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Question	Answer
My child's RESPs are at two brokerages. Is that a problem?	No, as long as you pick the child on each contribution. The tracker adds both towards ONE $50,000 limit and ONE $7,200 CESG maximum for that child.
Grandparents have an RESP for my child too.	Add their past contributions to Settings row 49, and log new ones as Contributions for that child. Every RESP counts towards the same limit.
My RRSP contribution in February does not show in my RRSP room.	Correct: a contribution from January 1 to March 1 counts for last year. The room block counts March 2 to March 1.
Why does "Max CESG this year" show $1,000?	The child has unused grant room from earlier years. Contributing $5,000 for that child this year collects the full $1,000.
A chart is blank.	Menu: Rebuild Dashboard Charts.
New year?	Make a copy, change B7, update B23 and B24 (CRA My Account), B31 and B32 (Notice of Assessment) and each child's rows 49 and 50, and keep logging below your old rows.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca. Always confirm your own TFSA room in CRA My Account, your RRSP limit on your Notice of Assessment and your children's grants with your RESP provider. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca